

NewsQuest

Reporter Packet

Seven missions about 9/11 and its helpers, the Nepal flood, and robot doctors. All you need is a pencil. Do as many as you like, in any order.

Press pass

Reporter name

Date I started

My favorite story in this issue

Optional: draw yourself as a reporter

My press points

When you finish a mission, ask a grown-up to check it with the answer key. Write your points here.

Mission	Points	Out of
1. Real or fake? 9/11 edition		16
2. 9/11 mystery case files		18
3. The day the mountain moved		10
4. Two truths and a fib		12
5. Stack the skyscrapers		11
6. Robot job pitch		5
7. Wonder Wall question		6
Total		78

For grown-ups

Every mission is optional, and each takes 10 to 15 minutes. The answer key is a separate sheet, so keep it with you while your child works. The 9/11 mysteries focus on the helpers, but the topic can feel heavy, so you may want to do Missions 1 and 2 together. When your child is done, take a clear photo of each page they completed, plus this cover (with their name on each page), and send them to your club leader before our next session.

Real or fake? 9/11 edition

Points ____ / 16

Good reporters check their facts. Read each statement and **circle REAL or FAKE**. A grown-up can check your answers and read you the surprising stories behind them.

1	In 1974, a tightrope walker walked on a wire strung between the tops of the Twin Towers.	REAL	FAKE
2	On 9/11, every plane flying over the US was ordered to land. About 4,500 planes landed within a few hours.	REAL	FAKE
3	After 9/11, every airport in the world closed for a week.	REAL	FAKE
4	Only firefighters helped rescue people on 9/11.	REAL	FAKE
5	Everyone who died on 9/11 was from the United States.	REAL	FAKE
6	Two days after 9/11, the band at Buckingham Palace in London played the US national anthem.	REAL	FAKE
7	On 9/11, the Twin Towers were the tallest buildings in the world.	REAL	FAKE
8	The Tribute in Light is made with lasers.	REAL	FAKE
9	The Tribute in Light is sometimes switched off for a few minutes to protect birds.	REAL	FAKE
10	The new One World Trade Center stands exactly where the Twin Towers stood.	REAL	FAKE
11	In 2002, the Maasai people of Kenya gave 14 cows to the United States as a gift of comfort.	REAL	FAKE
12	Every year on September 11, schools and offices close for a national holiday.	REAL	FAKE
13	The last steel column removed from Ground Zero was covered in messages and photos, and it's now in the 9/11 museum.	REAL	FAKE
14	At the Flight 93 memorial, a tower holds 40 wind chimes, one for each passenger and crew member.	REAL	FAKE
15	The Pentagon is in Washington, DC.	REAL	FAKE
16	US troops captured Osama bin Laden and put him on trial.	REAL	FAKE

The one that surprised me most was number ____ because

9/11 mystery case files

Points ____ / 18

It has been 25 years since September 11, 2001. These mysteries are about the helpers. Write your guess first. Stuck? Hints are hidden on other pages of this packet. Only turn to the next hint when you need it, and tick a box for each hint you read. Fewer hints means more points.

Case 1: The number puzzle

A new tower now stands at the World Trade Center. It is exactly **1,776 feet** tall. The builders picked that number on purpose. Why?

My guess:

Hint 1 is on page 5. Hint 2 is on page 7. Hints I read: ☐ 1 ☐ 2

Case 2: The great boatlift

On 9/11, bridges, tunnels and subways into Manhattan shut down. Huge crowds were stuck at the tip of the island. Then boats started arriving: ferries, tugboats, fishing boats, even private sailboats. Nobody had planned it. How many people did the boats carry to safety? **Circle one.**

A. 5,000

B. 50,000

C. 500,000

Many captains weren't asked or paid to come. Why do you think they came?

9/11 mystery case files

Name _____

Case 3: The town that said welcome

After the attacks, all flights into the US were stopped, even planes already over the ocean. **38 planes** landed in one small town. Where?

My guess: _____

Hint 1 is on page 6. Hint 2 is on page 8. Hint 3 is on page 9. Hints I read: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3

Case 4: Who am I?

Read one clue, write your guess, then move on to the next clue. Try not to read ahead!

Clue 1 I was found in the rubble at Ground Zero, weeks after 9/11.

My guess: _____

Clue 2 I was badly burned, with just one living branch.

My guess: _____

Clue 3 People nursed me back to health and then brought me home.

My guess: _____

Reporter interview (+2 bonus)

Ask a grown-up: "If 7,000 strangers suddenly landed in our town tonight, what could we do to help?"

Who I interviewed: _____

The day the mountain moved

Points ____ / 10

These eight moments from the Nepal and Tibet flood are all mixed up. Read them all, then write the letters on the mountain trail below, from what happened first (at the top) to what happens last (at the bottom).

A 900 students and teachers run to higher ground just in time.

B Glaciers in the Himalayas keep shrinking and getting weaker.

C India sends bridges that can be built from pieces.

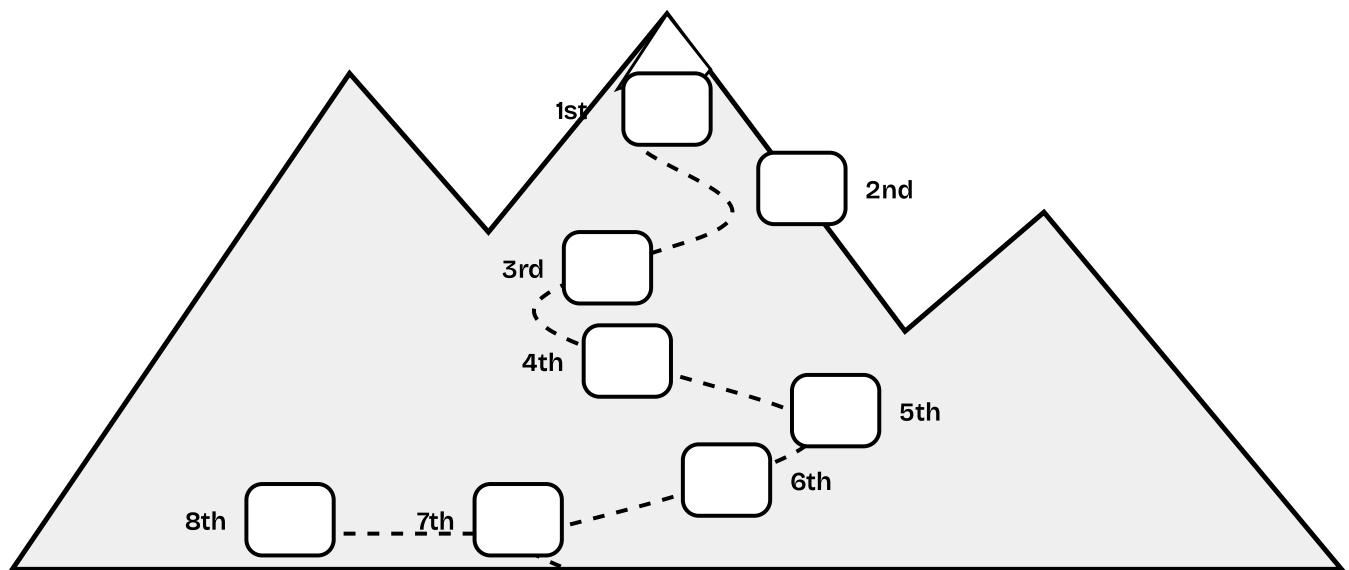
D A giant piece of glacier breaks off, 17,000 feet up.

E Scientists watch new lakes that could burst and flood again.

F Satellites spot unusually warm weather high on the mountain.

G Helicopters and 21,000 rescuers search for survivors.

H A wall of water, mud and rocks races down the river valley.



Think about it: which moments happened long before the flood day? What does that tell us about big disasters?

☐ I peeked at the time words (upside down below)

Time words, in no particular order: within 30 minutes (A) · over 30 years (B) · days later (C) · August 26, morning (D) · what happens next (E) · weeks before (F) · the next days (G) · minutes later (H)

Case 1, Hint 1 The number is a year.

Two truths and a fib

Points ____ / 12

Each round has two true facts and one fib. **Circle the letter of the fib.** Then write that letter in the secret word boxes. If you find every fib, you'll spell a mountain word!

Round 1

- ☐ **R** "Himalaya" comes from Sanskrit and means "home of snow."
- ☐ **A** Nepal's flag is the only national flag in the world that isn't a rectangle.
- ☐ **S** Glaciers are solid blocks of ice that never move.

Round 2

- ☐ **O** The Himalayas are called the "Third Pole" because they hold more ice than anywhere except the Arctic and Antarctica.
- ☐ **E** Himalayan glaciers feed giant rivers like the Ganges, Indus, Brahmaputra and Yangtze.
- ☐ **U** The rivers fed by Himalayan glaciers give water to about 1,000 people.

Round 3

- ☐ **K** Seismometers can feel any big shake, not just earthquakes.
- ☐ **M** Plain water is more destructive than a debris flow.
- ☐ **L** A debris flow is a fast mix of ice, water, mud and rocks, like wet concrete.

Round 4

- ☐ **P** The glacier broke off about 17,000 feet up, more than 3 miles high.
- ☐ **M** Mount Everest is shorter than Mount Whitney in California.
- ☐ **N** Nepal has 8 of the world's 14 mountains taller than 8,000 meters.

Round 5

- ☐ **I** A glacial lake outburst flood happens when a lake freezes solid.
- ☐ **D** A Bailey bridge is carried in pieces and bolted together, without heavy machines.
- ☐ **W** Tibet sits on the "Roof of the World," a plateau more than 14,000 feet high on average.

Round 6

- ☐ **B** When the glacier first collapsed, it looked like an earthquake to scientists.
- ☐ **H** People from 30 countries were nearby because Nepal is famous for trekking and climbing.
- ☐ **T** Nepal's flag is a green square with a white star.

Secret word:

1	2	3	4	5	6
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Stack the skyscrapers

Points ____ / 11

The Empire State Building is **1,454 feet** tall. How many Empire State Buildings would you stack to reach each place? Show your working. A calculator is allowed, and so is a grown-up's help!

Where the glacier broke

17,000 feet

About ____ buildings

Mount Whitney, California

14,505 feet

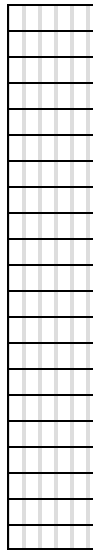
About ____ buildings

The top of Mount Everest

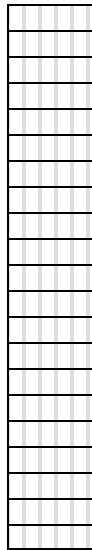
29,032 feet

About ____ buildings

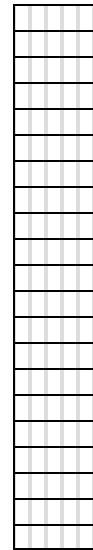
Color the towers. Each little block is one Empire State Building. Start at the bottom and color up to your answer for each place.



Glacier break



Mount Whitney



Mount Everest

Build it (+2 bonus)

Pick a block, book, or Lego brick to be your Empire State Building. Build an Everest tower using your answer. How many did you use? ____ Did it stand up? ____ Ask a grown-up to snap a photo!

 **Case 1, Hint 2** Think about July 4th, fireworks, and a famous signed document.

Robot job pitch

Points ____ / 5

Doctors are already doing surgery with robot helpers. Now you invent a robot! Circle where it will work and fill in your pitch. Drawing it is optional, just for fun.



Home



School



Hospital



Planet & animals



Space



Somewhere else

Robot name

What job does it do?

What special part helps it do that job?

Think deeper: one job a robot should never do, and why

Optional: draw your robot here, just for fun.

**Case 3, Hint 2** It's on the island of Newfoundland, and about 10,000 people live there.

My Wonder Wall question

Points ____ / 6

Good reporters ask "why?" and "how do we know?" Write one question that a story in this issue made you wonder about. It can be a question nobody knows the answer to yet. We'll put everyone's questions on our Wonder Wall at the next session.

Which story? Circle one.

9/11

Nepal floods

Robot doctors

Something else

Need a start?

Why did...

How do we know...

What would happen if...

Who decided...

My question:

Ask a grown-up (+3)

Read your question to a grown-up. What was their answer?

All done? Send it in!

☐ Fill in my points on the cover ☐ Take a photo of each page I did ☐ Send the photos to my club leader before our next session

 **Case 3, Hint 3** Its name is also the word for a male goose.